

No teacher needed

Weavers are brilliant builders, but they don't have lessons or copy other birds. They just know how to weave their nest. This "knowing without learning" is called instinct.

Cup-shaped nests have walls to stop eggs from rolling out.

Baby birds don't need pillows—they have soft feathers to lie on.

Nests in trees and bushes are kept dry by the leaves—they form little umbrellas!

Lichen is used to camouflage the nest.

Dried moss helps to keep the eggs warm.

This cup-nest was built by squashing! The greenfinch pressed the material into place with its breast as it spun round in a circle.



Knitted nest

The weaver uses his beak and feet to tie the grass into knots!



Grass is sewn into the nest to form a ring.



After weaving the walls, roof, and door, he hangs upside down from his home and invites a female to move in.



Burrowing bee-eater

Carmine bee-eaters nest underground! The male chooses a sandy riverbank and pecks at the earth. When the dent is big enough to cling to, he starts to dig with his beak and feet. The female moves in when all the work is done!